

FIELD NOTES: SCIENCE VOCABULARY

Sneak Peek: What's Dropping This Year

New videos, infographics, and podcast episodes go live every Sunday at 9 AM, all year long — one topic at a time, right alongside what each grade is learning that week. Here's the full lineup for the 2026–27 school year, so you can see what's coming.

This schedule follows the actual school calendar and each grade's science curriculum pace (Grade 6, 7, and 8 each move through their own set of topics across all 38 instructional weeks of the year). Some terms are already live — those are left off the list below since you can already watch, read, or listen to them today.

CURRICULUM MAP

Topic order and pacing per grade, mapped to the actual 2026–27 school calendar.

Grade 6 • Elevate Science Course 1

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
Introduction to Matter	Wk 1–4	Aug 16 – Sep 6	7
Solids, Liquids, and Gases	Wk 5–8	Sep 13 – Oct 4	7
Energy	Wk 9–12	Oct 11 – Nov 1	7
Thermal Energy	Wk 13–17	Nov 8 – Dec 6	8
Introduction to Earth's Systems	Wk 18–19	Dec 13 – Jan 3	4
Weather in the Atmosphere	Wk 20–23	Jan 10 – Jan 31	6
Minerals and Rocks in the Geosphere	Wk 24–27	Feb 7 – Feb 28	6
Plate Tectonics	Wk 28–30	Mar 7 – Mar 21	6
Earth's Surface Systems	Wk 31–33	Apr 4 – Apr 18	5
Living Things in the Biosphere	Wk 34–38	Apr 25 – May 23	8

Grade 7 • Elevate Science Course 2

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
The Cell System	Wk 1–7	Aug 16 – Sep 27	8
Human Body Systems	Wk 8–10	Oct 4 – Oct 18	4
Reproduction and Growth	Wk 11–13	Oct 25 – Nov 8	3
Ecosystems	Wk 14–17	Nov 15 – Dec 6	5
Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems	Wk 18–22	Dec 13 – Jan 24	6
Distribution of Natural Resources	Wk 23–25	Jan 31 – Feb 14	3
Human Impacts on the Environment	Wk 26–28	Feb 21 – Mar 7	3
Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation	Wk 29–32	Mar 14 – Apr 11	5
Electricity and Magnetism	Wk 33–36	Apr 18 – May 9	5
Information Technologies	Wk 37–38	May 16 – May 23	3

Grade 8 • Elevate Science Course 3

Topic	Weeks	Dates	Terms
Atoms and the Periodic Table	Wk 1–6	Aug 16 – Sep 20	7
Chemical Reactions	Wk 7–10	Sep 27 – Oct 18	4
Forces and Motion	Wk 11–15	Oct 25 – Nov 22	6
Genes and Heredity	Wk 16–20	Nov 29 – Jan 10	6
Change Over Time	Wk 21–23	Jan 17 – Jan 31	4
History of Earth	Wk 24–26	Feb 7 – Feb 21	3
Energy in the Atmosphere and Ocean	Wk 27–28	Feb 28 – Mar 7	2
Climate	Wk 29–31	Mar 14 – Apr 4	3
Earth-Sun-Moon System	Wk 32–34	Apr 11 – Apr 25	4
Solar System and the Universe	Wk 35–38	May 2 – May 23	5

WEEKLY DROP SCHEDULE

Every Sunday at 9 AM. — just means that grade doesn't have something new that particular week.

Week / Drop Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 1 Sun Aug 16 (school: Aug 18–Aug 21)	<i>Introduction to Matter</i> Mass • Physical Change	<i>The Cell System</i> Photosynthesis • Cell	<i>Atoms and the Periodic Table</i> Periodic Table • Proton
Wk 2 Sun Aug 23 (school: Aug 24–Aug 28)	Matter	Organelle	Neutron
Wk 3 Sun Aug 30 (school: Aug 31–Sep 4)	Physical Property	Nucleus	Electron
Wk 4 Sun Sep 6 (school: Sep 8–Sep 11)	Chemical Change	Mitochondria	Atom
Wk 5 Sun Sep 13 (school: Sep 14–Sep 18)	<i>Solids, Liquids, and Gases</i> State of Matter • Melting Point	Cell Membrane	Element
Wk 6 Sun Sep 20 (school: Sep 21–Sep 25)	Boiling Point • Evaporation	Chloroplast	Chemical Bond
Wk 7 Sun Sep 27 (school: Sep 28–Oct 2)	Condensation • Sublimation	Cellular Respiration	<i>Chemical Reactions</i> Chemical Reaction
Wk 8 Sun Oct 4 (school: Oct 5–Oct 9)	Pressure	<i>Human Body Systems</i> Organ • Tissue	Reactant
Wk 9 Sun Oct 11 (school: Oct 13–Oct 16)	<i>Energy</i> Energy • Work	Organ System	Product
Wk 10 Sun Oct 18 (school: Oct 19–Oct 23)	Mechanical Energy	Homeostasis	Conservation of Mass
Wk 11 Sun Oct 25 (school: Oct 26–Oct 30)	Conservation of Energy	<i>Reproduction and Growth</i> Asexual Reproduction	<i>Forces and Motion</i> Speed
Wk 12 Sun Nov 1 (school: Nov 2–Nov 6)	Force	Sexual Reproduction	Friction
Wk 13 Sun Nov 8 (school: Nov 9–Nov 13)	<i>Thermal Energy</i> Temperature • Heat	Fertilization	Gravity
Wk 14 Sun Nov 15 (school: Nov 16–Nov 20)	Conduction • Convection	<i>Ecosystems</i> Producer	—
Wk 15 Sun Nov 22 (school: Nov 23–Nov 24)	Radiation	Consumer	—
Wk 16 Sun Nov 29 (school: Dec 1–Dec 4)	Insulator	Decomposer	<i>Genes and Heredity</i> Gene • Chromosome
Wk 17 Sun Dec 6 (school: Dec 7–Dec 11)	Conductor	Food Chain	DNA

Week / Drop Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 18 Sun Dec 13 (school: Dec 14–Dec 18)	<i>Introduction to Earth's Systems</i> Geosphere · Hydrosphere	<i>Populations, Communities, and Ecosystems</i> Population	Heredity
Wk 19 Sun Jan 3 (school: Jan 4–Jan 8)	Atmosphere · Biosphere	Community	Trait
Wk 20 Sun Jan 10 (school: Jan 11–Jan 15)	<i>Weather in the Atmosphere</i> Weather · Humidity	Carrying Capacity	Mutation
Wk 21 Sun Jan 17 (school: Jan 19–Jan 22)	Air Mass · Front	Limiting Factor	<i>Change Over Time</i> Evolution · Natural Selection
Wk 22 Sun Jan 24 (school: Jan 25–Jan 29)	Air Pressure	—	Adaptation
Wk 23 Sun Jan 31 (school: Feb 1–Feb 5)	Precipitation	<i>Distribution of Natural Resources</i> Renewable Resource	Fossil Record
Wk 24 Sun Feb 7 (school: Feb 8–Feb 11)	<i>Minerals and Rocks in the Geosphere</i> Mineral · Rock	Nonrenewable Resource	<i>History of Earth</i> Geologic Time Scale
Wk 25 Sun Feb 14 (school: Feb 16–Feb 19)	Igneous · Sedimentary	Fossil Fuel	Relative Dating
Wk 26 Sun Feb 21 (school: Feb 22–Feb 26)	Metamorphic	<i>Human Impacts on the Environment</i> Pollution	Era
Wk 27 Sun Feb 28 (school: Mar 1–Mar 5)	Rock Cycle	Conservation	<i>Energy in the Atmosphere and Ocean</i> Ocean Current
Wk 28 Sun Mar 7 (school: Mar 8–Mar 12)	<i>Plate Tectonics</i> Tectonic Plate · Continental Drift	Sustainability	Atmospheric Circulation
Wk 29 Sun Mar 14 (school: Mar 15–Mar 19)	Earthquake · Volcano	<i>Waves and Electromagnetic Radiation</i> Wave · Amplitude	<i>Climate</i> Climate
Wk 30 Sun Mar 21 (school: Mar 22–Mar 24)	Fault · Tsunami	Wavelength	Climate Change
Wk 31 Sun Apr 4 (school: Apr 5–Apr 9)	<i>Earth's Surface Systems</i> Weathering · Erosion	Frequency	Greenhouse Effect
Wk 32 Sun Apr 11 (school: Apr 12–Apr 16)	Deposition · Sediment	Electromagnetic Spectrum	<i>Earth-Sun-Moon System</i> Rotation · Revolution
Wk 33 Sun Apr 18 (school: Apr 19–Apr 23)	Glacier	<i>Electricity and Magnetism</i> Electric Force · Magnetic Force	Lunar Phase
Wk 34 Sun Apr 25 (school: Apr 26–Apr 30)	<i>Living Things in the Biosphere</i> Organism · Cell	Circuit	Eclipse
Wk 35 Sun May 2 (school: May 3–May 7)	Classification · Species	Current	<i>Solar System and the Universe</i> Solar System · Planet

Week / Drop Date	Grade 6	Grade 7	Grade 8
Wk 36 Sun May 9 (school: May 10–May 14)	Virus · Bacteria	Voltage	Star
Wk 37 Sun May 16 (school: May 17–May 21)	Protist	<i>Information Technologies</i> Signal · Digital Signal	Galaxy
Wk 38 Sun May 23 (school: May 24–May 28)	Fungus	Analog Signal	Orbit